

H2GUARD · REQUIREMENTS

H2Guard requirements

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.4	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Recommendations accepted by Amish (DDR-002); R1 placement rule, R3 timed escalation, R13 scope and R14 budget restated; status from HGD-CAL-001 v0.2
0.3	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	TRL 3 status from HGD-CAL-001; set points and inventory rule adopted for TRL 3 per HGD-DDR-001 (pending Amish's review); R6 names the series relay and hardware latch; R12 names the bump test cup and port
0.2	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First measurable requirements for TRL 2, with status against the concept estimates
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Initial scaffold

H2Guard requirements

These are first-pass requirements for the concept. Targets are proposals for review, not user-validated needs, and will be revised after sessions with the first users. At TRL 3 each requirement is checked by calculation in HGD-CAL-001 v0.2 against the design in HGD-PRC-001 v0.4 and the model in `cad/src/model.py`. No requirement is now **not met**. Three are at risk: R4 (assumed sensor t90), R7 (assumed fan curve) and R13 (installation, 4.1 h against 4 h). R1 cannot be verified without sensor data. On 2026-09-25 Amish accepted the review recommendations (HGD-DDR-002): R1 gains the head placement rule, R3 gains the timed escalation, R13 excludes the fan and grille wall openings as builder's work, and R14 follows the new \$265 budget. The set points (R2, R3) and the inventory rule (R9) are decided by Amish (HGD-DDR-001, D2 and D5).

Table 1. Requirements. LFL is the lower flammability limit of hydrogen in air, taken as 4.0 % by volume, so 10 % LFL is 0.4 % vol and 25 % LFL is 1.0 % vol. Tags in brackets refer to lines of HGD-CAL-001.

ID	Requirement	Target	Verification (TRL 3 or later)	Status at TRL 3 (HGD-CAL-001)
R1	Measure hydrogen at the high point of the room	0 to 100 % LFL (0 to 4 % vol), resolution 1 % LFL or better; head within 0.3 m of the ceiling and directly above each likely leak point, with a second head where leak points are far apart; the horizontal offset limit is set at TRL 4 from the measured plume width	Sensor datasheet review; installation rule in the precis; offset limit by test at TRL 4	Not verifiable at TRL 3: resolution needs sensor data; height met (ports 175 mm below the ceiling [L1]); plume radius about 141 mm at the ports [E7]
R2	Warn early	At 10 % LFL (0.4 % vol): fan to boost, amber light, intermittent sounder; self-clearing	Set point and logic review	Met on paper: design leak plume at the head about 15 % LFL [E2]
R3	Trip and shut off the supply	At 25 % LFL (1.0 % vol): valve closed, fan on boost, continuous sounder and beacon; latched until reset with a key and the reading is below 10 % LFL. A warning held for 5 min also closes the valve and latches in the same way (firmware rule)	Set point and logic review	Met by design: on the plume axis the design leak trips (about 30 % LFL [E2]); off the axis the escalation closes the valve at 5.6 min with 28 L released [F7]
R4	Respond fast enough	Sensor t90 of 30 s or less; alarm within 60 s of a step to 1.1 % vol (twice t90, following the ISO 26142 test approach); valve closed within 2 s of the trip	Datasheets, then a bench test at TRL 4	At risk: 35.7 s leak to valve closed with an assumed 30 s t90; 0.17 s trip to valve closed [F3, F4]
R5	Fail safe	The supply is closed within 2 s of any of: loss of 24 V power, sensor open or short circuit, heater failure, controller watchdog timeout, fan stopped (no tachometer pulses for 10 s)	Failure modes and effects analysis (FMEA)	Met on paper: worst listed fault 1.12 s [F6]; the first-pass FMEA finds four dangerous undetected faults outside this list
R6	Trip without firmware	A hardware comparator on the catalytic sensor bridge, with its own latch, opens a relay in series with the microcontroller's valve switch at the trip level, even if the microcontroller has stopped	Circuit review	Met by design (block diagram level)
R7	Ventilate the room	Continuous exhaust at high level of 5 air changes per hour or more (150 m3/h for the 30 m3 reference room); boost of 10 air changes per hour or more; make-up air at low level on the far side	Fan curve against duct and grille losses	At risk: 347 m3/h boost with the re-specified fan on an assumed curve; the TRL 2 fan gave 237 m3/h [G3]
R8	Keep the design leak below the trip level	With the design leak of 5 L/min and continuous ventilation, the well-mixed room stays below 10 % LFL	First-order dilution calculation	Met on paper: 5.0 % LFL well mixed and in the upper layer [D1, D3]
R9	Limit what can leak	Hydrogen inventory that could be released into the room is 1 % of room volume or less at atmospheric pressure (300 L for 30 m3), unless a flow restrictor limits release to the design leak	Installation rule and host project review	Met by design as an installation rule; H2Bench's tank is 2.6 % of the limit; a 0.13 mm orifice at 10 bar gauge limits a failure to 5 L/min [B3, B4]

ID	Requirement	Target	Verification (TRL 3 or later)	Status at TRL 3 (HGD-CAL-001)
R10	Alert people	Sounder 85 dB(A) or more at 1 m and a red beacon visible from the room entrance	Component ratings	Met on paper: 90 dB at 1 m, 76 dB at 5 m [K2]
R11	Keep mains out of the self-built parts	All self-built wiring 24 V DC; mains only inside a certified power supply; power draw 60 W or less	Design review	Met on paper: 48.3 W peak in the warning state [H2]
R12	Be checkable in use	Bump test with 1 % vol hydrogen span gas through the test port and head cup in 2 min or less; self-test button runs the alarm, fan boost and valve close; event log of readings, warnings, trips and resets kept for 90 days or more	Design review	Met on paper: bump reading settles in about 67 s [J1]; log 2.07 MB in 4 MB of flash [J3]; cup delivery factor unknown
R13	Install simply	Mounted and wired by one person with hand tools in 4 h or less, excluding the gas fitting, which a competent person makes, and the wall openings for the fan and make-up grille, which are builder's work	Task time estimate; walk-through at TRL 4	At risk: 4.1 h on estimate, 5 min over [M1] (6.0 h if the openings were included)
R14	Stay within the concept budget	Parts \$265 or less (<code>budget_usd</code>)	Priced BOM	Met on paper: \$264.00 [N1], \$1 margin on indicative prices
R15	Avoid adding ignition sources in the ceiling layer	Fan never switched on in a flammable mixture (runs continuously); controller, relays and power supply mounted at least 1 m below the ceiling; sensor ports behind sintered flame arrestors	Design review	Met by design: controller top 1,025 mm below the ceiling [L2]; not certified for hazardous areas, and the catalytic element runs hot

■ Assumptions

- Reference room: 4 x 3 x 2.5 m (30 m³), one door, general ventilation unknown and taken as zero.
- Design leak: 5 L/min of hydrogen, representing a failed fitting downstream of a regulator with a flow restrictor. A small electrolyzer of about 100 W makes only about 0.39 L/min (HGD-CAL-001, B1), so this covers it with margin. A failed regulator on an unrestricted cylinder can release far more, and H2Guard does not protect against that (R9).
- Hydrogen rises from the leak as a buoyant plume and collects under the ceiling. HGD-CAL-001 uses plume theory for the head and a well-mixed or displacement model for the room.
- Set points follow common practice for hydrogen detection (warning at 10 % LFL, shutdown at 25 % LFL); ISO 26142 describes alarm levels at 25 % or 50 % LFL. The set points are decided by Amish, 2026-09-25 (HGD-DDR-001, D2).
- Budget: the \$265 in `project.yaml` (raised from \$180 by Amish's acceptance of the recommendation, HGD-DDR-002) covers the H2Guard kit including the fan and make-up grille, but not the gas system, span gas, wall openings or installation labor.